

COMMERCIAL DRIVER HANDBOOK

North Eastern Region (NER) Operations

1. NER Terrain & Mountain Driving Rules

Driving across North East India requires specialized technical skills due to steep gradients, narrow winding passes, and extreme weather hazards.

- **Right of Way:** Vehicles ascending uphill always have strict right of way. Downhill traffic must yield, pull over safely, or reverse if necessary.
- **Gear Selection:** Engage low gears before commencing steep descents. Never coast in neutral or depress the clutch fully while driving downhill.
- **Overtaking Restrictions:** Overtaking is strictly prohibited on hairpins, blind curves, single-lane bridges, and stretches prone to continuous rockfall.
- **Weather Conditions:** During heavy monsoon downpours or dense winter fog (common in high-altitude zones like Tawang or Nathu La), drivers must activate hazard lights, reduce speed to below 20 km/h, or park in safe, designated laybys.

2. Inter-State Border Permits & Transit Documentation

Cross-border freight transport throughout the eight NER states demands strict regulatory compliance check-ins at state border gates.

- **Inner Line Permit (ILP):** Drivers and crew operating or stopping in Arunachal Pradesh, Nagaland, Mizoram, and Manipur must possess valid ILPs or official transit passes.
- **E-Way Bill Compliance:** Active GST E-Way Bills are mandatory for all inter-state movements. Any delay caused by landslides must be promptly updated on the portal to prevent expirations.
- **Restricted/Protected Area Permits (RAP/PAP):** Required for international border shipping zones. Ensure paperwork is validated at the state checkpoints before entry.

3. Emergency Protocol: Landslides & Flash Floods

Landslides, mudslides, and flash floods are common across the NER, requiring proactive emergency maneuvers:

- **Immediate Halt:** If rockfall or rolling debris is observed ahead, halt the vehicle immediately at a clear distance. Never try to speed through an active slide zone.
- **Safe Parking:** Pull the vehicle flush against the valley side if possible, avoiding areas directly under vertical, unstable rock cliffs or loose soil slopes.
- **Communication Protocol:** Relay your exact GPS coordinates or nearest milestone marker to the central logistics hub immediately. If cellular network is down, wait for official highway patrol teams.

4. Quick Reference Matrix: Key National Highways

Highway	Key Transit Corridor	Primary Critical Challenges
NH-06	Assam - Meghalaya - Mizoram	Severe monsoon mudslides, heavy fog layers
NH-29	Assam - Nagaland - Manipur	Steep hairpins, heavy multi-axle congestion
NH-13	Arunachal Trans-Highway	High altitude, extreme icing, narrow single-lanes